ERC Starting Grant 2026

ectype — a copy without an original

ECTOCINEMA

New Topologies of Cinematic Time

Dr Daniel Chávez Heras

King's College London · 60 months

From recorded to predicted temporalities...

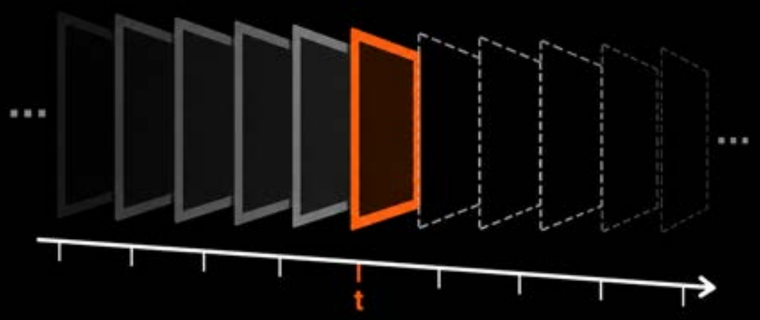
1900

→

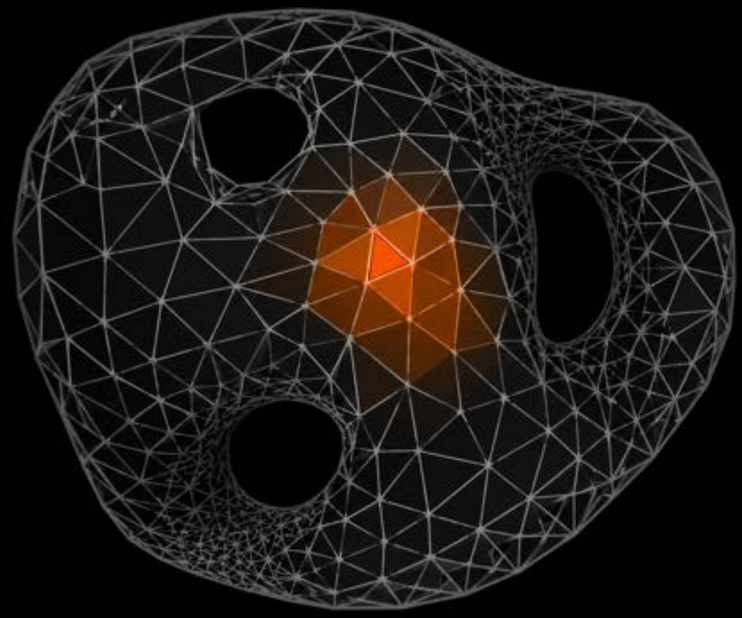
2024

...a computational model of cinematic time.

What if time had a different shape?



TIMELINE



TIME-MESH

Rethinking screen archives

Reshaping editing interfaces

Redrawing disciplinary boundaries

From film and video analytics, to **growing synthetic screen cultures** in the lab.

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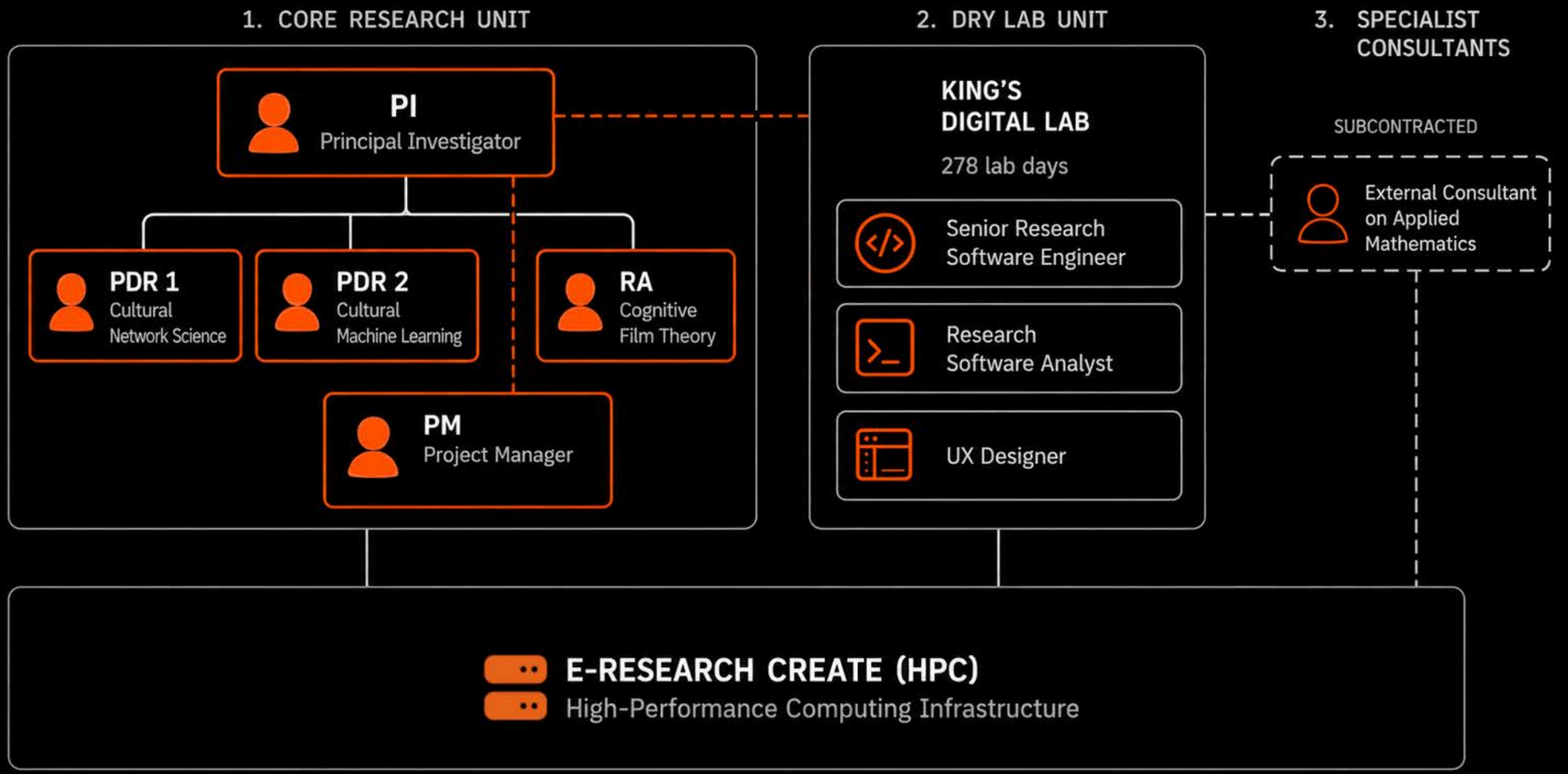
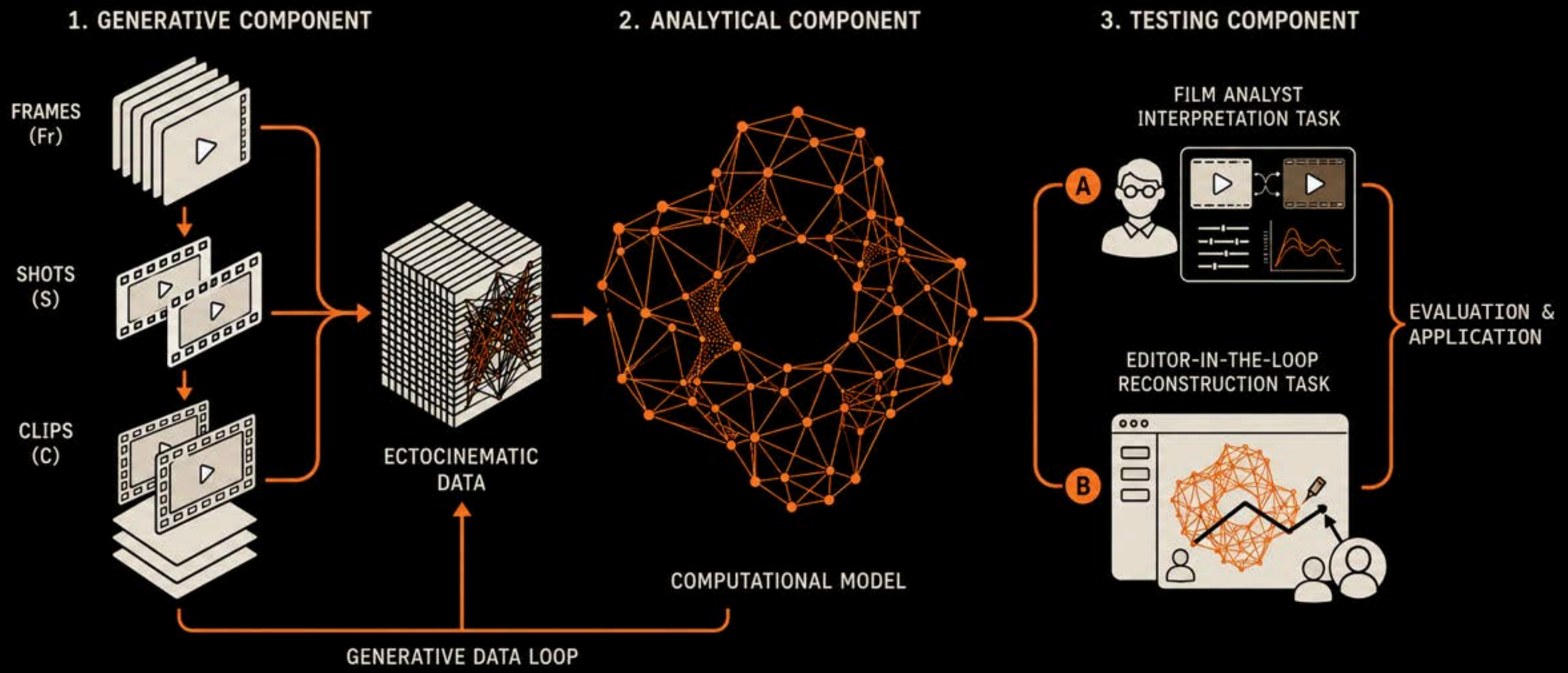
End of presentation


1. CORE RESEARCH UNIT
PI
Principal Investigator
PDR 1
Cultural
Network Science
PDR 2
Cultural
Machine Learning
RA
Cognitive
Film Theory
PM
Project Manager
2. DRY LAB UNIT
KING'S
DIGITAL LAB
278 lab days
Senior Research
Software Engineer
Research
Software Analyst
UX Designer
3. SPECIALIST
CONSULTANTS
SUBCONTRACTED
External Consultant
on Applied
Mathematics
E-RESEARCH CREATE (HPC)
High-Performance Computing Infrastructure


1. GENERATIVE COMPONENT
2. ANALYTICAL COMPONENT
3. TESTING COMPONENT
FRAMES (Fr)
SHOTS (S)
CLIPS (C)
ECTOCINEMATIC DATA
FILM ANALYST INTERPRETATION TASK
A
EDITOR-IN-THE-LOOP RECONSTRUCTION TASK
B
EVALUATION & APPLICATION
COMPUTATIONAL MODEL
GENERATIVE DATA LOOP

README MIT license

FrameSense

FrameSense is a highly modular command line tool to pre-process your video collections.

Status: alpha

Current focus: functional minimum viable product. The current implementation is still buggy and slow. Consolidation and optimisation will come at a later stage.

Requirements

- python 3.10+
- Docker or Singularity

Initial set Up

1. Clone this repository anywhere on your system;
2. Copy `docs/collections.json` to the folder containing your video collections and adapt its contents to your needs. All paths `collections.json` are relative to that file.
3. Copy `docs/.env` in the folder that contains `framesense.py` and adapt the values to your environment. `FRAMESENSE_COLLECTIONS` should be the absolute path to your copy of `collections.json`.
4. Create the python virtual environment: `python3 -m venv venv`
5. Activate the virtual environment: `source venv/bin/activate`
6. Install the required packages: `pip install -r requirements.txt`

Concepts

In FrameSense your collection is broken down into a hierachy of smaller units. A `Collection` contains `videos`, which are made of `Clips`. Each Clip is a sequence of `Shots`. And each Shot is composed of a series of still `Frames`.

Each operation provided by FrameSense works at on a particular unit in that hierarchy.

Releases

No releases published
Create a new release

Packages

No packages published
Publish your first package

Contributors 3

- geoffroy-noel-ddh Geoffroy Noël
- chavezheras Daniel
- aider-chat-bot Aider

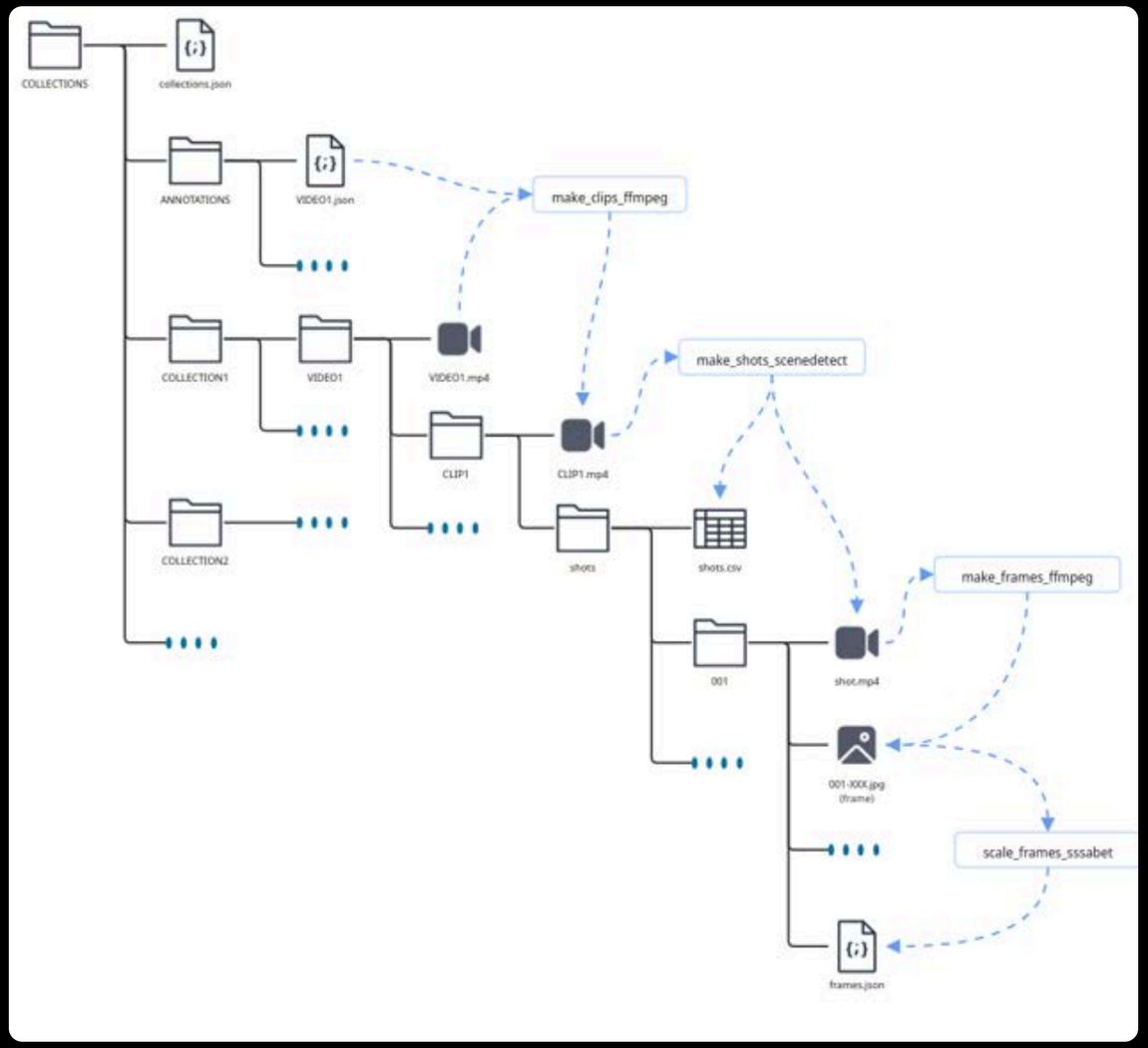
Languages

Python 93.0% Dockerfile 5.2% Shell 1.8%

Suggested workflows

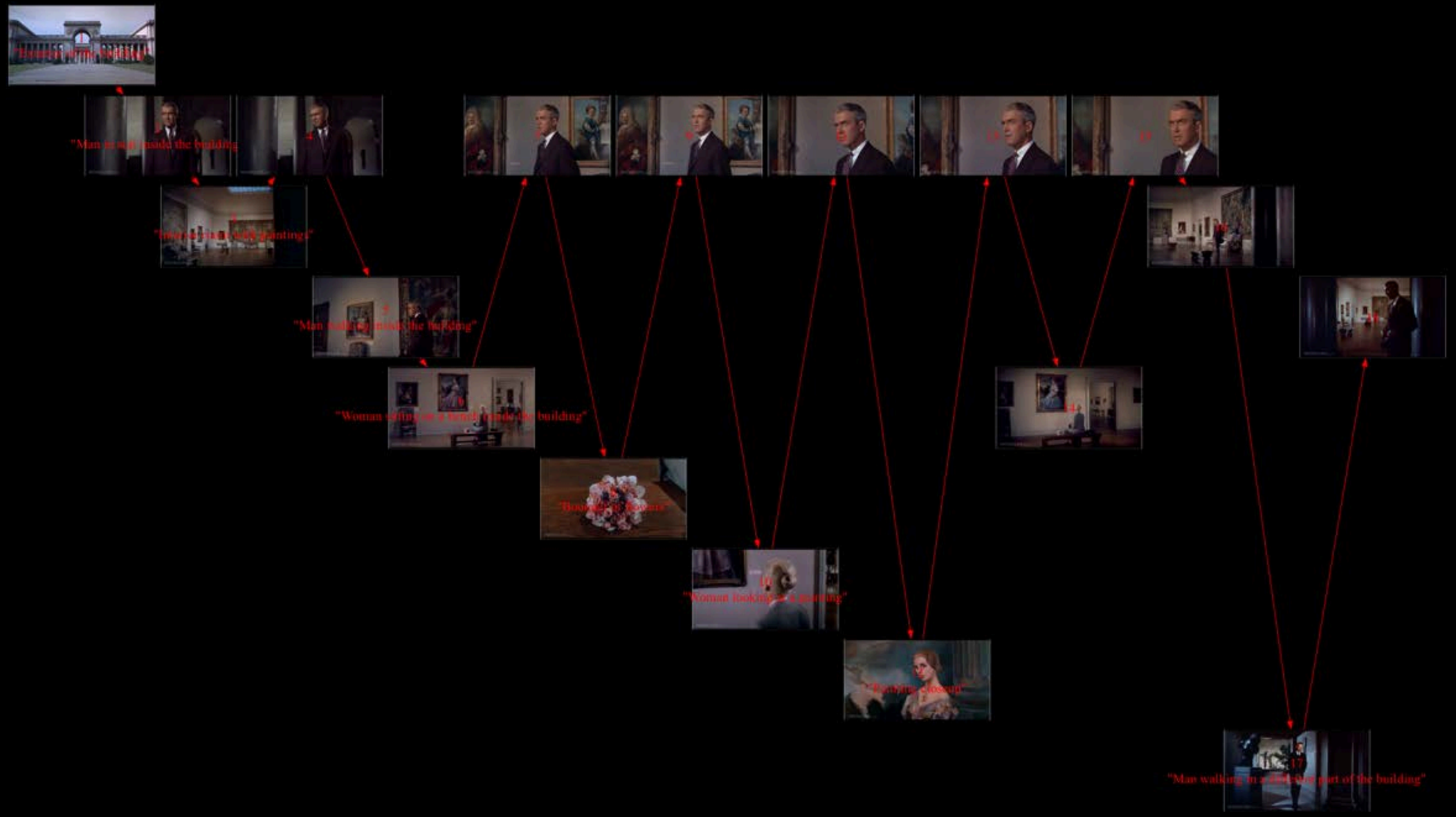
Based on your tech stack

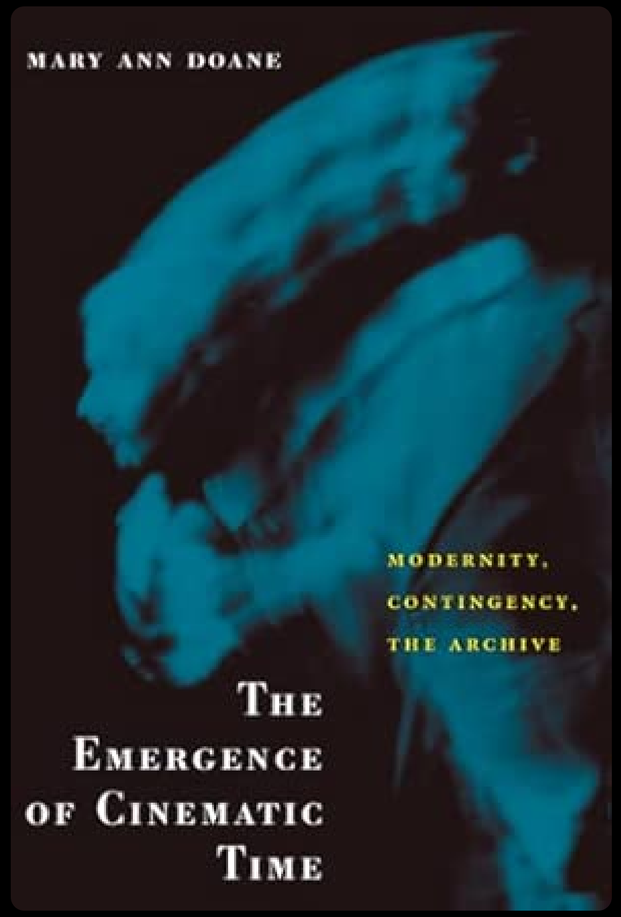
- Python application — Configure — Create and test a Python application.
- Python package — Configure — Create and test a Python package on multiple Python versions.
- Publish Docker Container — Configure — Build, test and push Docker image to GitHub Packages.

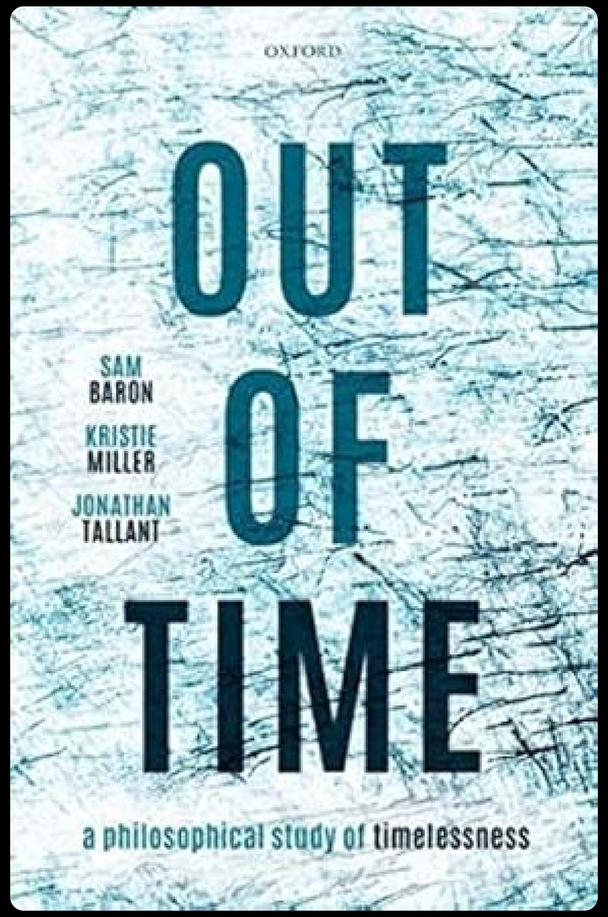


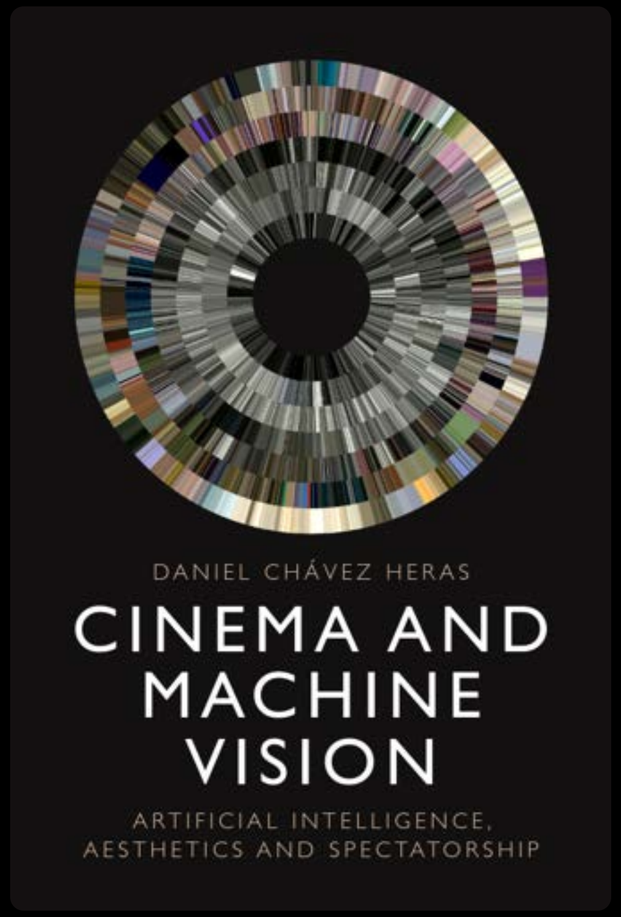
SCULPTING TIME WITH COMPUTERS EXPERIMENTS

ADDITIONAL SLIDES


"Man is still inside the building"
"Woman sitting on a bench inside the building"
"Woman looking at a painting"
"Man walking in a different part of the building"

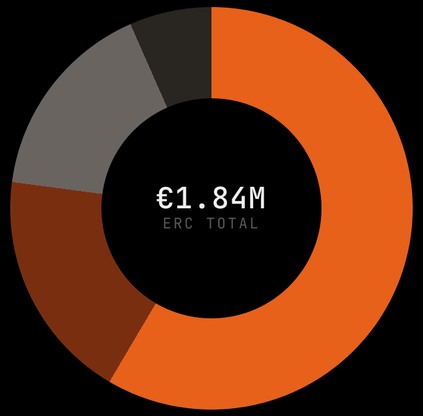

MARY ANN DOANE
MODERNITY,
CONTINGENCY,
THE ARCHIVE
THE EMERGENCE OF CINEMATIC TIME


OXFORD
OUT OF TIME
SAM BARON
KRISTIE MILLER
JONATHAN TALLANT
a philosophical study of timelessness


DANIEL CHÁVEZ HERAS
CINEMA AND MACHINE VISION
ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, AESTHETICS AND SPECTATORSHIP

RESOURCES

ADDITIONAL SLIDES



Personnel	58.5%	€1,078k
Dry Lab (KDL + HPC)	18.6%	€342k
Indirect costs	16.3%	€300k
Travel, publications & other	6.6%	€122k